TOPIC 3 · INTERACTIVE DASHBOARDS WITH CUSTOM SKILLS
LAB 8 THEME · INTERACTIVE FILTERS AND REFRESH

Lab 8 — Test Dashboard Filters and a Data Refresh

Maps to	LO3: build and validate an interactive Excel maintenance dashboard
Duration	35 minutes
Tools	Excel Copilot · Microsoft 365 Copilot web
Mock data	data/Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx
Lab files	data/templates/water-service-dashboard/SKILL.md (Reviewed dashboard Skill for reruns)
Course	GenAI for Engineers · v2.4
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-8

Goal

Test a finished dashboard: filter it with slicers, check an empty result, then add two rows and watch every number update.

What You Will Build

Northstar_Refresh_Test.xlsx with the dashboard updated to 122 work orders.

Prerequisites

- Microsoft 365 account with Copilot available in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook. Availability depends on the assigned licence and tenant settings; confirm access with the trainer before class.
- Desktop Excel on Windows or Mac. Download this lab folder and open the files straight from its data folder; save any new file in the same folder. All data is fictional.

Data note

Northstar Water Services is a fictional water-pipe maintenance and service company. All service hubs, staff and work orders are synthetic. Use the fixed reporting date 2026-09-30; missing facts remain UNKNOWN. Proposals do not change real assignments. Training email drafts are never sent.

Steps

Step 1. Open the dashboard. Open data/Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx in Excel and go to the Dashboard sheet.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Total : 120
Backlog : 60
Overdue : 50
```

Step 2. Filter one site. Click Woodlands Hub in the Site slicer and check the tiles. Then select the slicer's Clear Filter button.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Total : 24
Backlog : 8
Overdue : 7
Closed : 16
On time : 10 of 16
Cost : S$6,668.50
```

Step 3. Try an empty result. Click New in the Status slicer. The on-time rate shows N/A because no New job is closed. Clear the slicer.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Check : on-time rate shows N/A, not 0%
```

Step 4. Add two rows. Use File > Save As to save a copy named Northstar_Refresh_Test.xlsx. Copy the two rows on the Refresh_Test_Rows sheet and paste them in the first empty row under the table on Work_Orders. Go back to the Dashboard.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Total : 122
Closed : 49
Backlog : 61
Overdue : 51
Cost : S$36,227.50
```

Step 5. Ask Copilot to check. Open Copilot, choose Chat only and send the prompt. Then save.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - CHAT ONLY:
Check that every KPI tile and chart on the Dashboard includes the two new work orders,
WO-2026-0121 and WO-2026-0122. List any number that did not update.
```

Copy buttons for every prompt: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-8

Test It

Check	Expected result
Slicer	Woodlands Hub: 24 total, 8 backlog, 7 overdue, 16 closed, 10 of 16 on time, S$6,668.50.
Empty result	Status New: on-time rate N/A.
Refresh	122 total, 49 closed, 61 backlog, 51 overdue, S$36,227.50.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot cannot see my file	In Excel, save the file and open Copilot again. In Word, PowerPoint or Outlook, upload the file with + > Upload images and files, and upload it again after you change it.
A number is different from the lab	Clear any slicers or filters, check the table has no extra rows, then ask again in a new chat.
A button or feature is missing	Check you are signed in with your course account and Microsoft 365 is up to date, then tell your trainer.

Challenge

Repeat the task for one different site and explain how the filter scope changes the result. Keep the original verified output.

Reflection

Which evidence proves the output is correct, and which decision still needs a person?